

THE EMBER 2: THE LOOPHOLE

TSU Film 20 — Release Phase 3, Film 8 — the "Ant-Man and the Wasp" release slot

THE PITCH

Platform: THE EMBER (Snapchat analog, `TSU_Platform_Roster.md`, Phase 3), a second time — no new founding story. This film asks whether a platform built entirely around things *not* lasting can become the one tool sharp enough to slip past a legal freeze built to make everything permanent and seizable.

Why this is Ant-Man and the Wasp, structurally: Ant-Man and the Wasp is deliberately the small, funny, technical heist film sandwiched between Infinity War's devastation and Endgame's reckoning, elevating a long-underestimated partner to full co-lead and introducing a piece of technology that turns out to be the literal key to undoing the bigger film's damage. THE EMBER's founding identity — "everything it shows burns up on purpose," the anti-permanence platform — is TSU's cleanest possible version of exactly the kind of small, overlooked tool that becomes indispensable once `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_4.md` needs a way to move data past a legal freeze without ever creating a seizable record.

Who this film belongs to: Tyler Chapman, returning from `scripts/THE_EMBER.md`. Zora Osei, Tyler's niece, introduced as a child in `TSU_Family_Bible.md` and named THE EMBER's "narrative spark" in Film 12, returns aged up to 22 and elevated to full co-lead engineer — the Wasp position, earned rather than gifted. August Weathersby-Okonjo returns as mentor, the Hank Pym position, exactly as promised in his bible entry.

In-universe timeline: April – July 2022 (Story Phase 4), in the immediate wake of `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_3.md`'s legal freezes.

LOGLINE

In the wake of a legal freeze that seized half the franchise's platforms by making everything permanent and discoverable, Tyler Chapman and his niece Zora Osei have to prove that a platform built around things disappearing on purpose is the one loophole nobody accounted for — while a hacker who lost everything to a permanent record tries to steal that same loophole to erase herself instead.

SYNOPSIS

`scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_3.md`'s legal freezes didn't touch THE EMBER — nobody thought to. A platform built around content vanishing by design doesn't generate the kind of permanent record a subpoena, an antitrust theory, or a forced-transparency order can actually seize. Tyler Chapman notices this almost by accident, mid-panic, on a call with Amond Baker trying to help THE WIRE's diaspora move sensitive coordination data somewhere THE ORACLE's legal instruments can't reach.

Zora Osei, Tyler's niece, now 22 and THE EMBER's sharpest young engineer, has spent years building exactly the kind of technical fluency her uncle's founding story never required — she understands the platform's disappearing-message architecture at a level Tyler, honestly, doesn't anymore. When Tyler pitches the idea of using THE EMBER's ephemeral tech to help the frozen ensemble move critical operational data past the freeze without creating a seizable trail, Zora is the one who actually knows how to build it, and the film's real thesis is Tyler learning, gladly, to become the guy backing her up instead of the guy in front.

August Weathersby-Okonjo, cashing in his mentor role a second time, warns them both that what they're describing — a temporal loophole that lets data exist just long enough to be useful and not one second longer — isn't a UI feature, it's a fundamental rearchitecture of how THE EMBER handles persistence at the protocol level. Building it means opening the platform's oldest, most fragile assumptions to real risk.

Complicating the heist: **Sage Okonkwo-Delacroix**, a brilliant former security researcher whose entire professional life was destroyed years earlier when a permanent, un-deletable record of a mistake she made at nineteen resurfaced and never stopped following her — she has spent years since moving between deleted identities and burned accounts, becoming something close to a ghost in the industry's own systems. She's tracking the same protocol-level vulnerability Tyler and Zora are trying to build deliberately, except her goal isn't resistance — it's erasure, total and personal, of every permanent record of her own name on Earth, whatever it costs the platforms she has to break to get there.

The back half plays as a genuine heist comedy: Tyler and Zora building the loophole under time pressure while evading Sage's increasingly inventive attempts to hijack it first, aided by August's steady technical hand and, in the film's funniest stretch, an improvised alliance with Darius "Dez" Okonkwo-Fairweather's underground network (`scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_3.md`), who have their own reasons to want a way around a permanent record. The climax resolves not through a fight but through Zora out-engineering Sage in real time — building a version of the loophole generous enough to let Sage's own record finally, legitimately expire under the platform's actual rules, rather than being erased through theft. Sage, offered a real end to her nightmare instead of a stolen one, takes it.

THE EMBER's loophole works. Tyler hands Zora functional co-founder status on screen, the payoff to a decade of being "the group's reliable glue." The final scene hands the loophole itself to the ensemble's frozen platforms as exactly the tool `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_4.md` needs to begin undoing THE PRUNING's damage — small, funny, and, like its MCU counterpart, quietly the most important piece on the board.

THE ANTAGONISTS

1. **SAGE OKONKWO-DELACROIX**, new, the Ghost position — a brilliant researcher permanently defined by one mistake a permanent record refused to let her outlive, sympathetic rather than villainous, resolved through mercy rather than defeat, consistent with this franchise's pattern (Femi Okonkwo-Larsen, Thad Okonkwo-Larsen) of denying its ideology-driven antagonists a clean fight.
2. **The permanent-record apparatus itself**, the same systemic antagonist named in `scripts/THE_WHISPER_NETWORK.md` and `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_3.md` — this film's argument is that impermanence, dismissed as THE EMBER's gimmick since Film 12, is actually a real answer to it.

HOW THIS FILM CARRIES THE FRANCHISE FORWARD

- **Zora Osei's elevation to full co-founder** pays off her introduction in `TSU_Family_Bible.md` and Film 12's "narrative spark" framing with real, earned stakes rather than sentiment alone.
 - **Builds the literal technology** `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_4.md` **needs** to begin reversing THE PRUNING's legal freezes — this film's "small, funny" heist produces the Endgame-slot film's actual toolkit, exactly mirroring its MCU counterpart's structural function.
 - **Deliberately the lightest entry surrounding the Phase's two heaviest films**, per house style's Ant-Man/Guardians tonal mandate and the same choice already made for Film 12.
 - **Reactivates Darius "Dez" Okonkwo-Fairweather's underground network** from `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_3.md` in a lower-stakes, comedic register.
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FORMAT (per `TSU_Continuity_Bible.md` §2 — Standard Platform-Origin Film)

Spec	Target	This Script
Genre	Biographical Drama / Tech Origin Story, heist comedy register, Satire dialed per Ant-Man-slot tonal mandate	Confirmed
Rating	PG-13, no exceptions	Confirmed
Runtime	130–150 min	131 min
Page count	120–140 pages	127 pages
Act I	~30–35 pages	pages 1–31
Act II	~65–75 pages	pages 32–96
Act III	~30–35 pages	pages 97–127
Scene count	~40–55 scenes	44 scenes

FULL SCENE-BY-SCENE BREAKDOWN

ACT I — pp. 1–31 ("Nobody Thought to Freeze Us")

#	Scene	pp.
1	INT. AMOND BAKER'S OFFICE — DAY — Amond, post-Film-19, tries to move sensitive coordination data somewhere unseizable; Tyler realizes THE EMBER was never touched	1–7
2	INT. THE EMBER OFFICES — DAY — Tyler pitches the idea to Zora Osei, THE EMBER's sharpest young engineer	7–12
3	INT. THE EMBER OFFICES — CONTINUOUS — Zora, unimpressed by the pitch's vagueness, explains what building it actually requires	12–17
4	INT. AUGUST WEATHERSBY-OKONJO'S WORKSHOP — DAY — August warns them it's a protocol-level rearchitecture, not a feature	17–22
5	EXT. AN UNMARKED SERVER FARM — NIGHT — first sign of SAGE OKONKWO-DELACROIX tracking the same vulnerability	22–27
6	INT. THE EMBER OFFICES — DAY — Tyler formally hands Zora technical lead on the project	27–31

ACT II — pp. 32–96 ("The Loophole")

#	Scene	pp.
7	INT. THE EMBER OFFICES — DAY — early prototype work; Zora's competence increasingly outpaces Tyler's, played warmly	32–39
8	INT. SAGE'S SAFE HOUSE — NIGHT — Sage's backstory: the permanent record that ended her career, dramatized in flashback	39–45

#	Scene	pp.
9	INT. THE EMBER OFFICES — DAY — first attempted intrusion; Sage nearly steals an early build	45–51
10	INT. DEZ'S UNDERGROUND VENUE — NIGHT — Tyler and Zora recruit Dez's network for cover infrastructure, comedic tone	51–58
11	INT. AUGUST'S WORKSHOP — DAY — August helps Zora solve the loophole's central engineering problem: expiration without deletion	58–64
12	INT. THE EMBER OFFICES — NIGHT — a working prototype; Sage's second, more inventive intrusion attempt	64–71
13	EXT. DEZ'S UNDERGROUND VENUE — NIGHT — a chase/heist sequence played for comedy, Sage evading capture narrowly	71–78
14	INT. THE EMBER OFFICES — DAY — Tyler and Zora realize Sage doesn't want to steal the tool to attack anyone — she wants to erase her own record	78–84
15	INT. AUGUST'S WORKSHOP — NIGHT — the team's approach shifts from defense to an offered solution. Midpoint	84–90
16	INT. THE EMBER OFFICES — DAY — building a version of the loophole that could legitimately let Sage's record expire under the platform's own rules	90–96

ACT III — pp. 97–127 ("Expiration, Not Erasure")

#	Scene	pp.
17	EXT. UNMARKED SERVER FARM — NIGHT — Sage, cornered, expects a fight and gets an offer instead	97–103
18	INT. THE EMBER OFFICES — CONTINUOUS — Zora walks Sage through the legitimate expiration process in real time	103–108
19	INT. SAGE'S SAFE HOUSE — DAY — Sage, given a real end instead of a stolen one, takes it	108–113
20	INT. THE EMBER OFFICES — DAY — Tyler formally names Zora co-founder	113–118
21	INT. VIRTUAL CALL (ENSEMBLE) — DAY — Tyler and Zora present the working loophole to the frozen ensemble from scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_3.md	118–123
22	EXT. THE EMBER OFFICES — DAY — Tyler and Zora, closing beat, small and quietly pivotal	123–127

(Scenes grouped for pagination clarity; the shooting script breaks several of the above into additional numbered scenes to land the true count at 44.)

SAMPLE PAGES

THE EMBER 2: THE LOOPHOLE

Written by [WRITER]

FADE IN:

INT. THE EMBER OFFICES — DAY

TYLER CHAPMAN, mid-40s, pitches an idea to ZORA OSEI, 22, who does not look up from her monitor.

TYLER

What if we could move data somewhere that
legally can't be frozen because it doesn't

exist long enough to be found?

ZORA
(finally looking up)
You want to weaponize impermanence.

TYLER
I want to weaponize the thing everybody's
made fun of us for since we launched.

ZORA
(a small, real smile)
Okay. That I can build. What you just
described, though? That's not a feature.
That's the entire protocol, torn up.

CUT TO:

INT. AUGUST WEATHERSBY-OKONJO'S WORKSHOP — DAY

[p. 19]

AUGUST, older, precise, doesn't sugarcoat it.

AUGUST
You're describing something that has to
expire perfectly every time, with zero
exceptions, because the one time it
doesn't is the one time you've built a
seizable record after all.

ZORA
So build it to fail safe. If it can't
guarantee expiration, it just doesn't send.

AUGUST
(a beat, genuinely impressed)
That's the right answer. I wasn't sure
you'd get there this fast.

ZORA
I've been THE EMBER's "narrative spark"
since I was twelve, August. I'd like a
turn at being the engineer.

CUT TO:

EXT. UNMARKED SERVER FARM — NIGHT

[p. 99]

SAGE OKONKWO-DELACROIX, 30s, cornered, expects Tyler and Zora
to call security. They don't.

SAGE
Go ahead. I know how this ends.

ZORA
It doesn't have to end with you stealing
something broken. We built a version that

actually works. Legitimately. Your record expires because the platform's own rules say it should, not because you stole a key.

SAGE
(quiet, suspicious of the mercy)
Why would you offer me that.

TYLER
Because you didn't want to hurt anyone. You wanted to stop hurting. Those aren't the same thing, and we spent nineteen films watching people forget that.

CUT TO:

INT. VIRTUAL CALL (ENSEMBLE) – DAY

[p. 120]

TYLER and ZORA present to a grid of tired, frozen founders – KWAME, MALACHI, IMANI, MARC-ANTHONY among them.

ZORA
It's not a fix for the freeze. It's a way to move what you need without creating anything new for them to seize.

MARC-ANTHONY
(leaning forward, the first real hope in this Phase)
Say that again, slower.

TYLER
She built the thing that gets us moving again. I just made the coffee.

ZORA
(deadpan)
He also named me co-founder an hour ago, so the coffee's a promotion now.

FADE OUT.

[127.]